

Masters Edition III Frequently Asked Questions
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Masters Edition III booster packs go on sale at the Magic Online (R) store at 9 a.m. (PST) on Monday September 7, 2009.

The Masters Edition III set becomes legal for play in the Classic, Classic (Vanguard), Freeform, Prismatic, Singleton, and Tribal Wars (Classic) formats on the day it goes on sale.

Masters Edition III release events begin Wednesday, September 9, 2009. Go to <http://www.wizards.com/magic/tcg/productarticle.aspx?x=mtg/tcg/mastersed3/productinfo> for more information.

The Masters Edition III set is a collection of Magic (TM) cards that were originally printed before the Mirage (TM) set was released. It's a 230-card, black-bordered set featuring 70 rares, 70 uncommons, 75 commons, and 15 basic lands. The Masters Edition III set is nonredeemable: Online cards from the Masters Edition III set can't be exchanged for physical cards.

No physical cards will exist with the Masters Edition III expansion symbol.

This FAQ has two sections, each of which serves a different purpose.

The first section ("General Notes") explains the mechanics and concepts in the set. The second section ("Card-Specific Notes") contains answers to the most important questions players might ask about a given card.

Items in the "Card-Specific Notes" section include full rules text for your reference. Not all cards in the set are listed.

GENERAL NOTES

Rules Changes

The rules of the Magic game have evolved over the years since the cards reprinted in the Masters Edition III set were originally released. Many card wordings, including creature types, have also significantly changed. Most Masters Edition III cards have been reworded in the Oracle card reference, which contains up-to-date text for all tournament-legal cards. Although the rules team has done its best to maintain cards' original functionality, some changes are inevitable.

Rarity Changes

Design philosophy regarding the kinds of cards that are appropriate for each commonality, in terms of both power level and complexity, have also evolved over the past decade. In order to create a set that's both balanced and exciting for Limited play, many of the cards in the Masters Edition II set appear at a different rarity than they did in their original sets.

Keyword Ability: Horsemanship

Horsemanship is a static ability seen on creatures. It's an evasion ability that essentially works the same way that flying does. The official rules for the horsemanship ability are as follows:

702.28. Horsemanship

702.28a Horsemanship is an evasion ability that appeared in the _Portal Three Kingdoms_(TM) set.

702.28b A creature with horsemanship can't be blocked by creatures without horsemanship. A creature with horsemanship can block a creature with or without horsemanship. (See rule 509, "Declare Blockers Step.")

702.28c Multiple instances of horsemanship on the same creature are redundant.

* Horsemanship doesn't interact with flying or reach.

* If a creature gains or loses horsemanship after blockers have been declared, it won't cause those blocks to change.

Keyword Ability: Rampage

Rampage is a triggered ability that can make a blocked creature bigger. The official rules for the rampage ability are as follows:

702.20. Rampage

702.20a Rampage is a triggered ability. "Rampage N" means "Whenever this creature becomes blocked, it gets +N/+N until end of turn for each creature blocking it beyond the first." (See rule 509, "Declare Blockers Step.")

702.20b The rampage bonus is calculated only once per combat, when the triggered ability resolves. Adding or removing blockers later in combat won't change the bonus.

702.20c If a creature has multiple instances of rampage, each triggers separately.

* For example, let's say that a creature with rampage 3 becomes blocked by five creatures. When the rampage ability resolves, the blocked creature will get +12/+12 until end of turn. (That's four instances of +3/+3.)

* If a creature with rampage is blocked by a single creature, the ability triggers but provides no bonus.

* The number of blocking creatures is determined when the ability resolves.

Supertype: Legendary

The _Masters Edition III_ set contains 62 "legendary" cards, representing one-of-a-kind creatures and other permanents. Legendary is a supertype. If two or more legendary permanents with the same name are on the battlefield, those permanents are immediately put into their owners' graveyards. This is a state-based action called the "legend rule."

* Permanents put into a graveyard as a result of the "legend rule" are not "destroyed" and thus can't be regenerated.

* No player gets priority between the time a legendary permanent enters the battlefield and the time the "legend rule" sends all legendary permanents with that name to their owners' graveyards. In other words, they can't be sacrificed, returned to their owners' hands, or otherwise affected in response.

* If two permanents with the same name are on the battlefield, but only one of them is legendary, the "legend rule" doesn't apply.

Supertype: World

The _Masters Edition III_ set contains six "world" enchantments: The Abyss, Nether Void, Storm World, Concordant Crossroads, Arboria, and Living Plane. These represent magic capable of moving the battle to a new world, leaving the previous one behind. World is a supertype. If a world permanent enters the battlefield, any world permanents that were already on the battlefield are immediately put into their owners' graveyards -- but the new world permanent stays on the battlefield. This is a state-based action called the "world rule." If two world permanents enter the battlefield at the same time, they're both immediately put into their owners' graveyards.

* Permanents put into a graveyard as a result of the "world rule" are not "destroyed" and thus can't be regenerated.

* No player gets priority between the time a world permanent enters the battlefield and the time the "world rule" sends the world permanents that have been on the battlefield the longest to their owners' graveyards. In other words, they can't be sacrificed, returned to their owners' hands, or otherwise affected in response.

* Unlike the "legend rule," the "world rule" doesn't care about the names of permanents. It cares only about the world supertype.

* Note that if more than one legendary permanent with the same name is on the battlefield, they're all put into their owners' graveyards, but if more than one world permanent is on the battlefield, the newest one is not put into its owner's graveyard.

Cycle: Dual Lands

Five of the original ten "dual lands" appear in the _Masters Edition III_ set: Bayou, Plateau, Scrubland, Tropical Island, and Volcanic Island.

Bayou
Land -- Swamp Forest

* Each dual land has the two mana abilities associated with its basic land types. For example, you can tap Bayou to add {B} or {G} to your mana pool.

* These dual lands have basic land types, but they aren't basic lands. Things that affect basic lands don't affect them. Things that affect basic land types do. For example, Land Tax ("search your library for up to three basic land cards") can't find Bayou, but Three Visits ("search your library for a Forest card") can.

Theme: "Slowtrips"

Cards like Fevered Strength were the predecessors of today's "cantrips." Cantrips are spells that have an additional "draw a card" effect on them. "Slowtrips" are spells that have an additional "draw a card at the beginning of the next turn's upkeep" effect on them. These cards set up a delayed triggered ability that triggers at the beginning of the upkeep of the very next turn. It doesn't matter whose turn it is.

Fevered Strength
{2} {B}
Instant
Target creature gets +2/+0 until end of turn.
Draw a card at the beginning of the next turn's upkeep.

* If the spell is countered for any reason (including for having all its targets become illegal), none of its effects happen. You won't draw a card at the beginning of the next turn's upkeep.

Theme: _Portal_ activation restrictions

Some cards that were originally printed in _Portal_ sets have activated abilities with the restriction "Activate this ability only during your turn, before attackers are declared."

Wu Longbowman

{2} {U}

Creature -- Human Soldier Archer

1/1

{T}: Wu Longbowman deals 1 damage to target creature or player. Activate this ability only during your turn, before attackers are declared.

* This restriction means that you can activate the ability only before the declare attackers step. If you choose not to declare any attackers that turn, that doesn't mean you can activate the ability later during the turn (such as during your end step).

CARD-SPECIFIC NOTES

All Hallow's Eve

{2} {B} {B}

Sorcery

Exile All Hallow's Eve with two scream counters on it.

At the beginning of your upkeep, if All Hallow's Eve is exiled with a scream counter on it, remove a scream counter from it. If there are no more scream counters on it, put it into your graveyard and each player returns all creature cards from his or her graveyard to the battlefield.

* The only thing that happens when All Hallow's Eve resolves is that it's exiled with two scream counters on it.

* All Hallow's Eve's triggered ability functions from the exile zone. This ability has an "intervening 'if' clause." It won't trigger at all unless All Hallow's Eve is exiled and has a scream counter on it (which can happen only if it resolves as a spell).

* Each creature returned to the battlefield by All Hallow's Eve enters the battlefield under its owner's control.

Amrou Kithkin

{W} {W}

Creature -- Kithkin

1/1

Amrou Kithkin can't be blocked by creatures with power 3 or greater.

* A creature with power 3 or greater can't be declared as a blocker for Amrou Kithkin. If the power of a creature that's already blocking Amrou Kithkin is increased to 3 or greater, it will continue to block Amrou Kithkin.

Anaba Spirit Crafter

{2} {R} {R}

Creature -- Minotaur Shaman

1/3

Minotaur creatures get +1/+0.

* Anaba Spirit Crafter's ability affects all Minotaurs, including Anaba Spirit Crafter itself.

Arborea

{2} {G} {G}

World Enchantment

Creatures can't attack a player unless that player cast a spell or put a nontoken permanent onto the battlefield during his or her last turn.

* Arborea doesn't stop creatures from attacking planeswalkers, regardless of what their controllers did or didn't do during their last turns.

* Arborea's effect cares whether a player put a nontoken permanent onto the battlefield. It's unusual for an ability to care who did the putting (as opposed to whose control the permanent entered the battlefield under), and requires careful reading of spells and abilities to see which player is instructed to put something onto the battlefield. For example, All Hallow's Eve's ability causes each player to return the creature cards from his or her graveyard to the battlefield. If All Hallow's Eve's controller has no creature cards in his or her graveyard, but another player does, only that other player puts a permanent onto the battlefield. It doesn't matter who controls the effect.

* Arborea's effect cares about the actions taken by players, not their results. If a player cast a spell during his or her last turn but that spell was countered, that player may still be attacked. The same is true if a player put a nontoken permanent onto the battlefield during his or her last turn, even if it's no longer on the battlefield by the time that player is attacked.

Arcades Sabboth

{2} {G} {G} {W} {W} {U} {U}

Legendary Creature -- Elder Dragon

7/7

Flying

At the beginning of your upkeep, sacrifice Arcades Sabboth unless you pay {G} {W} {U}.

Each untapped creature you control gets +0/+2 as long as it's not attacking.

{W}: Arcades Sabboth gets +0/+1 until end of turn.

* As long as Arcades Sabboth is untapped and isn't attacking, it'll get +0/+2 from its own third ability.

Ashes to Ashes

{1} {B} {B}

Sorcery

Exile two target nonartifact creatures. Ashes to Ashes deals 5 damage to you.

* If one of the targeted creatures is an illegal target by the time Ashes to Ashes resolves, it still exiles the other one and deals 5 damage to you.

* If both of the targeted creatures are illegal targets by the time Ashes to Ashes resolves, it's countered. It doesn't deal 5 damage to you.

Axelrod Gunnarson

{4} {B} {B} {R} {R}

Legendary Creature -- Giant

5/5

Trample

Whenever a creature dealt damage by Axelrod Gunnarson this turn is put into a graveyard, you gain 1 life and Axelrod deals 1 damage to target player.

* Each time a creature is put into a graveyard from play, check whether Axelrod Gunnarson had dealt any damage to it at any time during that turn. (This includes combat damage.) If so, Axelrod Gunnarson's second ability will trigger. It doesn't matter who controlled the creature or whose graveyard it was put into.

* If Axelrod Gunnarson and a creature it dealt damage to are both put into a graveyard at the same time, Axelrod Gunnarson's second ability will trigger.

* The player you target with Axelrod Gunnarson's ability doesn't have to be the player that controlled the creature that was put into a graveyard.

Banshee

{2} {B} {B}

Creature -- Spirit

0/1

{X}, {T}: Banshee deals half X damage, rounded down, to target creature or player, and half X damage, rounded up, to you.

* If the targeted creature or player is an illegal target by the time Banshee's ability resolves, the ability is countered. You won't be dealt damage.

Barl's Cage

{4}

Artifact

{3}: Target creature doesn't untap during its controller's next untap step.

* You may target any creature with this ability. It doesn't have to be tapped.

* If the targeted creature is untapped at the time its controller's next untap step begins, this ability has no effect. It won't apply at some later time when the targeted creature is tapped.

* Barl's Cage doesn't track the creature's controller. If the affected creature changes controllers before its old controller's next untap step, this ability will prevent it from being untapped during its new controller's next untap step.

Bartel Runeaxe

{3} {B} {R} {G}

Legendary Creature -- Giant Warrior

6/5

Vigilance

Bartel Runeaxe can't be the target of Aura spells.

* Bartel Runeaxe can be targeted by abilities from Auras.

* Although Bartel Runeaxe can't be targeted by Aura spells as they are cast, it can be enchanted. A spell or ability can move an Aura from another permanent onto Bartel, or can put an Aura onto the battlefield attached to Bartel.

Benthic Explorers

{3}{U}

Creature -- Merfolk Scout

2/4

{T}, Untap a tapped land an opponent controls: Add one mana of any type that land could produce to your mana pool.

* Untapping a tapped land an opponent controls is part of the cost of Benthic Explorers's ability. If no opponent controls a tapped land, the ability can't be activated.

* The types of mana are white, blue, black, red, green, and colorless.

* Benthic Explorers checks the effects of all mana-producing abilities of the land untapped to pay its cost, but it doesn't check the costs of those abilities. For example, Vivid Crag has the ability "{T}, Remove a charge counter from Vivid Crag: Add one mana of any color to your mana pool." If you untap a tapped Vivid Crag an opponent controls while paying for Benthic Explorers's ability, you can add one mana of any color to your mana pool. It doesn't matter whether that Vivid Crag has a charge counter on it.

* When determining what types of mana an opponent's land could produce, take into account any applicable replacement effects that would apply to that land's mana abilities (such as Contamination's effect, for example). If there is more than one, consider them in any possible order.

* Benthic Explorers doesn't care about any restrictions or riders an opponent's land (such as Ancient Ziggurat or Hall of the Bandit Lord) puts on the mana it produces. It just cares about types of mana.

Black Vise

{1}

Artifact

As Black Vise enters the battlefield, choose an opponent.

At the beginning of the chosen player's upkeep, Black Vise deals X damage to that player, where X is the number of cards in his or her hand minus 4.

* If the chosen player has four or fewer cards in his or her hand as Black Vise's ability resolves, the ability just won't do anything that turn.

* If Black Vise changes controllers, it will continue to affect the player chosen as it entered the battlefield, even if that player isn't an opponent of its current controller.

Blood Lust

{1}{R}

Instant

If target creature has toughness 5 or greater, it gets +4/-4 until end of turn. Otherwise, it gets +4/-X until end of turn, where X is its toughness minus 1.

* Blood Lust's effect is determined at the time it resolves. The effect won't change if the affected creature's toughness changes later in the turn. For example, say you control three Swamps and a Nightmare (which is thus 3/3). If Nightmare is affected by Blood Lust, it will get +4/-2 and become 7/1. If one of your Swamps then leaves the battlefield, Nightmare will become 6/0 and be put in the graveyard.

Bone Flute

{3}

Artifact

{2}, {T}: All creatures get -1/-0 until end of turn.

* The ability affects only creatures on the battlefield at the time it resolves. A creature that enters the battlefield later in the turn won't get -1/-0.

Burning of Xinye

{4} {R} {R}

Sorcery

You destroy four lands you control, then target opponent destroys four lands he or she controls. Then Burning of Xinye deals 4 damage to each creature.

* Burning of Xinye targets only an opponent. If that player is an illegal target by the time Burning of Xinye resolves, the entire spell is countered.

* The lands that will be destroyed aren't chosen until Burning of Xinye resolves.

* As Burning of Xinye resolves, first you destroy four lands you control (all at the same time), then the targeted opponent destroys four lands he or she controls (all at the same time). That player chooses which of his or her lands to destroy. Neither of you can choose to destroy an indestructible land.

* A land with a regeneration shield on it will regenerate from Burning of Xinye's destruction effect. However, the spell or ability that creates that shield must be cast or activated before Burning of Xinye starts to resolve.

* In a multiplayer game, only lands controlled by two players (you and the targeted opponent) are destroyed. However, Burning of Xinye will deal 4 damage to each creature, even those controlled by other players.

Call to Arms

{1} {W}

Enchantment

As Call to Arms enters the battlefield, choose a color and an opponent.

White creatures get +1/+1 as long as the chosen color is the most common color among nontoken permanents the chosen player controls but isn't tied for most common.

When the chosen color isn't the most common color among nontoken permanents the chosen player controls or is tied for most common, sacrifice Call to Arms.

* Call to Arms affects all white creatures, not just white creatures you control.

* If Call to Arms changes controllers, it will continue to check the nontoken permanents controlled by the player chosen as it entered the battlefield, even if that player isn't an opponent of its current controller.

* The game continually counts the number of nontoken permanents of each color the chosen player controls. Multicolored ones are counted for each of their colors; colorless ones are ignored. The moment the number of nontoken permanents of the chosen color that player controls is less than or equal to the number of permanents of one of the other colors that player controls, Call to Arms's second ability stops giving white creatures +1/+1 and its third ability triggers. Call to Arms will be sacrificed when the third ability resolves, even if those numbers have changed by then.

* Call to Arms's third ability is a "state trigger." Once a state trigger triggers, it won't trigger again as long as the ability is on the stack. If the ability is countered and the trigger condition is still true, it will immediately trigger again.

Chain Lightning

{R}

Sorcery

Chain Lightning deals 3 damage to target creature or player. Then that player or that creature's controller may pay {R} {R}. If the player does, he or she may copy this spell and may choose a new target for that copy.

* As Chain Lightning resolves, the targeted player, or the controller of the targeted creature, may copy it. The copy has the same text, target, and color of the resolving spell, though the player who's copying it may choose a new target for it. Once that copy is created (or not), the resolving Chain Lightning has finished resolving and leaves the stack.

* Since a copy of Chain Lightning has the same text as Chain Lightning, the player it targets, or the controller of the creature it targets, may copy it as it resolves, and the chain continues.

* If the targeted creature or player is an illegal target by the time Chain Lightning resolves, the spell is countered. It won't be copied.

City of Shadows

Land

{T}, Exile a creature you control: Put a storage counter on City of Shadows.

{T}: Add {X} to your mana pool, where X is the number of storage counters on City of Shadows.

* You can activate City of Shadows's second ability while it has no storage counters on it, though it won't add any mana to your mana pool in this case. You've still tapped it for mana, though, in case any abilities (such as the ability of a Fertile Ground enchanting it) care about that.

* Activating City of Shadows's second ability doesn't remove any storage counters from it.

Concordant Crossroads

{G}

World Enchantment

All creatures have haste.

* This ability affects all creatures, not just the ones you control.

Corrupt Eunuchs

{3} {R}

Creature -- Human Advisor

2/2

When Corrupt Eunuchs enters the battlefield, it deals 2 damage to target creature.

* If there are no other creatures on the battlefield when Corrupt Eunuchs enters the battlefield, it will have to target itself.

Cosmic Horror

{3} {B} {B} {B}

Creature -- Horror

7/7

First strike

At the beginning of your upkeep, destroy Cosmic Horror unless you pay {3} {B} {B} {B}. If Cosmic Horror is destroyed this way, it deals 7 damage to you.

* If you choose not to pay Cosmic Horror's upkeep cost, it deals 7 damage to you only if it's actually destroyed. If it regenerates or an effect has made it indestructible, it deals no damage.

Crimson Kobolds

{0}

Creature -- Kobold

0/1

Crimson Kobolds is red.

* Crimson Kobolds has a characteristic-defining ability. It works in all zones. If Crimson Kobolds loses all abilities (due to a card like Ovinize), it will still be red because the effect from its ability is applied before the "lose all abilities" effect is applied.

* If Crimson Kobolds is affected by a text-changing effect that changes the color word in its ability (if it's targeted by Sleight of Mind, for example), then its ability will cause it to be the new color word. That's because the text-changing effect is applied before Crimson Kobolds's ability is applied.

Dance of Many

{U} {U}

Enchantment

When Dance of Many enters the battlefield, put a token that's a copy of target nontoken creature onto the battlefield.

When Dance of Many leaves the battlefield, exile the token.

When the token leaves the battlefield, sacrifice Dance of Many.

At the beginning of your upkeep, sacrifice Dance of Many unless you pay {U} {U}.

* Dance of Many's second and third abilities track only the token created by that particular Dance of Many.

* If Dance of Many leaves the battlefield before its first ability has resolved, its second ability will trigger and do nothing. Then its first ability will resolve and put a token onto the battlefield. That token won't have any connection to a Dance of Many permanent, so it won't be exiled when a Dance of Many leaves the battlefield.

Desperate Charge

{2} {B}

Sorcery

Creatures you control get +2/+0 until end of turn.

* Desperate Charge affects only creatures you control at the time it resolves. A creature that enters the battlefield later in the turn won't get +2/+0.

Disharmony

{2} {R}

Instant

Cast Disharmony only during combat before blockers are declared.

Untap target attacking creature and remove it from combat. Gain control of that creature until end of turn.

* Disharmony can target any attacking creature. It doesn't have to be tapped.

* You may cast Disharmony on your own turn, targeting an attacking creature you control.

* Removing the targeted creature from combat means it's no longer an attacking creature. It can't be blocked and it won't assign or deal combat damage.

* If you cast Disharmony during an opponent's turn, you may then block with the creature you gain control of (assuming there's an attacking creature it can block).

Divine Intervention

{6} {W} {W}

Enchantment

Divine Intervention enters the battlefield with two intervention counters on it.

At the beginning of your upkeep, remove an intervention counter from Divine Intervention.

When you remove the last intervention counter from Divine Intervention, the game is a draw.

* When Divine Intervention's third ability resolves, the game ends immediately. The game is a draw, meaning neither player wins and neither player loses.

* Divine Intervention's third ability triggers only if its controller removes the last intervention counter from it. It doesn't matter how that happens. For example, if you control Divine Intervention and the last intervention counter is removed as a result of a Clockspinning you control, the ability will trigger. On the other hand, if the last intervention counter is removed as a result of a Clockspinning another player controls, the ability won't trigger (and won't ever be able to).

* In a multiplayer game played with the limited range of influence option, Divine Intervention won't necessarily end the entire game when its third ability resolves. All players within range of Divine Intervention will leave the game. They'll neither win nor lose; as far as they're concerned, the result of the game is a draw. All other players will continue playing.

Eightfold Maze

{2} {W}

Instant

Cast Eightfold Maze only during the declare attackers step and only if you've been attacked this step.

Destroy target attacking creature.

* If all the attacking creatures attack your planeswalkers, you can't cast Eightfold Maze. To cast it, a creature needs to have attacked you.

* If you're able to cast Eightfold Maze, it can target any attacking creature (including one attacking a planeswalker).

Evil Presence

{B}

Enchantment -- Aura

Enchant land

Enchanted land is a Swamp.

* The enchanted land loses its existing land types and any abilities printed on it. It now has the land type Swamp and has the ability to tap to add {B} to its controller's mana pool. Evil Presence doesn't change the enchanted land's name or whether it's legendary, basic, or snow.

Fellwar Stone

{2}

Artifact

{T}: Add to your mana pool one mana of any color that a land an opponent controls could produce.

* The colors of mana are white, blue, black, red, and green. Fellwar Stone can't be tapped for colorless mana, even if a land an opponent controls could produce colorless mana.

* Fellwar Stone checks the effects of all mana-producing abilities of lands your opponents control, but it doesn't check their costs. For example, Vivid Crag has the ability "{T}, Remove a charge counter from Vivid Crag: Add one mana of any color to your mana pool." If an opponent controls Vivid Crag and you control Fellwar Stone, you can tap Fellwar Stone for any color of mana. It doesn't matter whether Vivid Crag has a charge counter on it, and it doesn't matter whether it's untapped.

* When determining what colors of mana your opponents' lands could produce, take into account any applicable replacement effects that would apply to those lands' mana abilities (such as Contamination's effect, for example). If there is more than one, consider them in any possible order.

* Fellwar Stone doesn't care about any restrictions or riders your opponents' lands (such as Ancient Ziggurat or Hall of the Bandit Lord) put on the mana they produce. It just cares about colors of mana.

Firestorm Phoenix

{4} {R} {R}

Creature -- Phoenix

3/2

Flying

If Firestorm Phoenix would be put into a graveyard from the battlefield, return Firestorm Phoenix to its owner's hand instead. It can't be played again until its owner's next turn.

* The Firestorm Phoenix you return to your hand is tracked by its ability. As long as it remains in your hand, that particular card can't be played before your next turn begins, but a different Firestorm Phoenix in your hand can.

* The Firestorm Phoenix returned to your hand can't be played by any player (in case a spell or ability, such as the one on Mindleech Mass or Sen Triplets, allows an opponent to play a card from your hand).

Forked Lightning

{3} {R}

Sorcery

Forked Lightning deals 4 damage divided as you choose among one, two, or three target creatures.

* You divide the damage as you cast Forked Lightning, not as it resolves. Each target you choose must be assigned at least 1 damage.

Freyalise's Winds

{2} {G} {G}

Enchantment

Whenever a permanent becomes tapped, put a wind counter on it.

If a permanent with a wind counter on it would untap during its controller's untap step, remove all wind counters from it instead.

* During your untap step, first you determine which of your permanents will untap, then you untap them. If you control a permanent that says "You may choose not to untap [this permanent] during your untap step" and you decide not to untap it, no wind counters will be removed from it because it wouldn't untap. The same is true for a permanent you control that wouldn't untap due to a spell or ability (such as the one from Barl's Cage).

Gabriel Angelfire

{3}{G}{G}{W}{W}

Legendary Creature -- Angel

4/4

At the beginning of your upkeep, choose flying, first strike, trample, or rampage 3. Gabriel Angelfire gains that ability until your next upkeep. (Whenever a creature with rampage 3 becomes blocked, it gets +3/+3 until end of turn for each creature blocking it beyond the first.)

* Gabriel Angelfire will have the ability it gains through your next untap step, but will no longer have it during your next upkeep step.

Gaea's Touch

{G}{G}

Enchantment

You may play an additional land during your turn if that land is a basic Forest.

Sacrifice Gaea's Touch: Add {G}{G} to your mana pool.

* Gaea's Touch lets you play an additional land during your turn if it's a basic land and it has the land type Forest. (The two such cards are Forest and Snow-Covered Forest.)

* If you play a basic Forest during your turn, you must declare whether you're using your standard land play or Gaea's Touch's first ability to do so.

* If you play a land using Gaea's Touch's first ability, and then Gaea's Touch leaves the battlefield (because you activated its second ability, for instance), the land you played still counts as an additional land play for the turn. If you haven't already, you can still play a land using your standard land play.

Gauntlets of Chaos

{5}

Artifact

{5}, Sacrifice Gauntlets of Chaos: Exchange control of target artifact, creature, or land you control and target permanent an opponent controls that shares one of those types with it. If those permanents are exchanged this way, destroy all Auras attached to them.

* As you activate the ability, the targets you choose must be two artifacts, two creatures, or two lands. As the ability resolves, both targets will be legal only if they are two artifacts, two creatures, or two lands at that time as well, though they may be a different type than they were at the time the ability was activated. For example, if the targets were a creature and an artifact creature when the ability was activated, but the first target became a noncreature artifact by the time the ability resolves, both targets will still be legal (since they're both artifacts).

* If one of the targets is illegal by the time the ability resolves (because the wrong player controls it, or it's the wrong card type, or for any other reason), the exchange doesn't happen. The target that's still legal will remain under its controller's control. Since the exchange doesn't happen, no Auras are destroyed. (If both targets are illegal, the ability is countered.)

Guan Yu, Sainted Warrior

{3}{W}{W}

Legendary Creature -- Human Soldier Warrior

3/5

Horsemanship (This creature can't be blocked except by creatures with horsemanship.)

When Guan Yu, Sainted Warrior is put into your graveyard from the battlefield, you may shuffle Guan Yu into your library.

* If Guan Yu, Sainted Warrior is removed from the graveyard after the ability triggers but before it resolves, it won't get shuffled into your library.

* If a replacement effect has Guan Yu move to a different zone instead of being put into the graveyard, the ability won't trigger at all.

Halfdane

{1}{W}{U}{B}

Legendary Creature -- Shapeshifter

3/3

At the beginning of your upkeep, Halfdane's power and toughness become equal to the power and toughness of target creature other than Halfdane until the end of your next upkeep.

* Halfdane's ability acts as though it overwrites the power and toughness numbers in its lower right corner. The effect will overwrite any previous effects that set Halfdane's power and/or toughness to specific values (such as the same ability from the previous turn), but no other effects that modify its power and toughness.

* Note that the duration of Halfdane's ability is until the end of your next upkeep. If Halfdane's ability doesn't get a chance to resolve (because there are no legal targets when it triggers, or because it's countered), then the effect from the previous turn's ability will continue to work through the rest of that upkeep step. Then that effect will wear off, and Halfdane will revert to being 3/3, its printed power and toughness (unless some other effect is modifying what its power and toughness is).

Hammerheim

Legendary Land

{T}: Add {R} to your mana pool.

{T}: Target creature loses all landwalk abilities until end of turn.

* You can target any creature with Hammerheim's second ability, not just one with a landwalk ability. (Of course, the ability has no effect on a creature without a landwalk ability.)

* Causing a creature to lose landwalk abilities is useful only during the declare attackers step or earlier. Once the declare blockers step begins, it's too late to block the creature.

Hazon Tamar

{4}{R}{G}{W}

Legendary Creature -- Human Warrior

2/4

When Hazon Tamar enters the battlefield, put X 1/1 Sand Warrior creature tokens that are red, green, and white onto the battlefield at the beginning of your next upkeep, where X is the number of lands you control at that time.

When Hazon leaves the battlefield, exile all Sand Warriors.

* When Hazon Tamar's second ability resolves, all permanents with both the Sand and Warrior creature types are exiled, not just the Sand Warrior creature tokens it created. Permanents that have just one of those types are unaffected.

* The first ability creates a delayed triggered ability that triggers at the beginning of your next upkeep. It doesn't matter who controls Hazon Tamar at that time, or even if it's on the battlefield. The player who put Hazon onto the battlefield gets the Sand Warriors.

* Only Sand Warriors that are actually on the battlefield when Hazezon Tamar leaves the battlefield are affected when its second ability resolves. If Hazezon leaves the battlefield after the delayed triggered ability created by its first ability triggers but before that ability resolves, its second ability triggers and resolves first, then the Sand Warriors are put on the battlefield. Those Sand Warriors will remain on the battlefield indefinitely.

Heal

{W}

Instant

Prevent the next 1 damage that would be dealt to target creature or player this turn.

Draw a card at the beginning of the next turn's upkeep.

* You draw a card at the beginning of the next turn's upkeep after Heal resolves, regardless of whether 1 damage was actually prevented.

Heavy Fog

{1}{G}

Instant

Cast Heavy Fog only during the declare attackers step and only if you've been attacked this step.

Prevent all damage that would be dealt to you this turn by attacking creatures.

* If all the attacking creatures attack your planeswalkers, you can't cast Heavy Fog. To cast it, a creature needs to have attacked you.

* Heavy Fog prevents only damage that would be dealt to you by attacking creatures. It won't prevent damage attacking creatures would deal to creatures or planeswalkers you control.

* Heavy Fog prevents all damage attacking creatures would deal to you this turn, not just combat damage. Noncombat damage from those creatures is prevented only if they're still attacking at the time that damage would be dealt or, if the creature has left the battlefield by then, if it was an attacking creature at the time it left.

Hellfire

{2}{B}{B}{B}

Sorcery

Destroy all nonblack creatures. Hellfire deals X plus 3 damage to you, where X is the number of creatures put into all graveyards this way.

* Hellfire checks the number of creatures put into graveyards as the result of its effect, not the number of creatures destroyed as a result of its effect. For example, a replacement effect that says "If a creature would be put into a graveyard from the battlefield, exile it instead" won't affect whether a creature is destroyed or not, but will affect whether it's put into a graveyard or not.

* A creature that regenerates instead of being destroyed doesn't leave the battlefield, so it's not put into a graveyard.

* A token creature that's destroyed is put into its owner's graveyard, and will be counted by Hellfire's effect. (Immediately after Hellfire finishes resolving, the token will cease to exist.)

Hunting Cheetah

{2}{G}

Creature -- Cat

2/3

Whenever Hunting Cheetah deals damage to an opponent, you may search your library for a Forest card, reveal that card, put it into your hand, then shuffle your library.

* Hunting Cheetah's ability allows you to search your library for any card with the land type Forest, not just a card with the name Forest.

Illusionary Mask

{2}

Artifact

{X}: You may choose a creature card in your hand whose mana cost could be paid by some amount of, or all of, the mana you spent on {X}. If you do, you may cast that card face down as a 2/2 creature spell without paying its mana cost. If the creature that spell becomes as it resolves is face down and would assign or deal damage, be dealt damage, or become tapped, instead it's turned face up then assigns or deals damage, is dealt damage, or becomes tapped. Activate this ability only any time you could cast a sorcery.

* Both the amount and types of mana you spend on {X} are taken into account while you're choosing a creature card from your hand. For example, if you spent {U}{U} on {X}, you can choose a creature card with mana cost {U}{U}, {1}{U}, {2}, or {W/U}{W/U}, among other possibilities, but not one that costs {2}{U} or one that costs {G}.

* If you use the ability to cast a creature card face down, you must keep track of the amount and types of mana you spent on {X}. If that creature spell is moved from the stack to anywhere other than the battlefield, the resulting creature leaves the battlefield, or the game ends, the face-down card is revealed. If its mana cost couldn't be paid by some amount of, or all of, the mana you spent on {X}, all applicable penalties for casting a card illegally are assessed.

* While the creature card is face down, it's a 2/2 creature with no name, mana cost, color, creature type, abilities, or expansion symbol. Since it has no mana cost, its converted mana cost is 0.

* Since the creature enters the battlefield face down, any "when this enters the battlefield" or "as this enters the battlefield" abilities it would have if it were face up won't work. They also won't work when the creature is turned face up, since it's already on the battlefield by that time.

* You may look at a face-down spell or permanent you control at any time.

* You may not turn a face-down spell face up. You may not turn a face-down permanent face up unless it would have morph while face up or an effect specifically allows you to turn it face up. Illusionary Mask's ability has you turn a face-down creature face up if it would assign damage, deal damage, be dealt damage, or become tapped, but not for any other reason. For example, if you use Illusionary Mask's ability to cast a black creature face down, you can't turn it face up just because it's being targeted by Terror.

* As noted above, you can turn a face-down permanent face up if it would have morph while face up. This applies to creatures you cast face down as a result of Illusionary Mask's effect. The rest of Illusionary Mask's effect applies to it as well.

* A creature spell you cast by using Illusionary Mask's ability can be countered.

* Illusionary Mask's ability will continue to apply to creatures cast face down with it, even if Illusionary Mask has left the battlefield.

Infuse

{2}{U}

Instant

Untap target artifact, creature, or land.

Draw a card at the beginning of the next turn's upkeep.

* You may target any artifact, creature, or land, not just a tapped one. If the targeted permanent is already untapped as Infuse resolves, Infuse won't affect it, but you'll still draw a card at the beginning of the next turn's upkeep.

Ivory Guardians

{4}{W}{W}

Creature -- Giant Cleric

3/3

Protection from red

Creatures named Ivory Guardians get +1/+1 as long as an opponent controls a nontoken red permanent.

* The ability of an Ivory Guardians will affect itself as well as all other creatures named Ivory Guardians (not just the ones you control).

* Each ability applies a maximum of once, even if an opponent controls multiple nontoken red permanents or multiple opponents each control a nontoken red permanent.

* The abilities from multiple Ivory Guardians are cumulative. For example, if you control two different Ivory Guardians and an opponent controls a nontoken red permanent, each of your Ivory Guardians will be 5/5.

Kjeldoran Frostbeast

{3}{G}{W}

Creature -- Elemental Beast

2/4

At end of combat, destroy all creatures blocking or blocked by Kjeldoran Frostbeast.

* Kjeldoran Frostbeast's ability triggers only if it's still on the battlefield when the end of combat step begins (after the combat damage step). For example, if it blocks a 7/7 creature and is destroyed, its ability won't trigger at all. The 7/7 will remain on the battlefield.

* Its ability will destroy all creatures it's currently blocking or blocked by, not necessarily the creatures it had blocked or become blocked by during that combat phase. For example, if Kjeldoran Frostbeast is dealt lethal combat damage and regenerates, it's removed from combat. Its ability will trigger at end of combat, but since it's no longer blocking or blocked by any creatures, the ability won't do anything.

Knowledge Vault

{4}

Artifact

{2}, {T}: Exile the top card of your library face down.

{0}: Sacrifice Knowledge Vault. If you do, discard your hand, then put all cards exiled with Knowledge Vault into their owner's hand.

When Knowledge Vault leaves the battlefield, put all cards exiled with Knowledge Vault into their owner's graveyard.

* You don't get to look at the cards exiled with Knowledge Vault.

* If you activate Knowledge Vault's second ability, all that happens at that time is that you pay a cost of {0}. As the ability resolves, you must sacrifice Knowledge Vault. This is mandatory. If you are able to do

so, you discard your hand and put all cards exiled with Knowledge Vault into their owners' hands. If you aren't able to do so because Knowledge Vault left the battlefield or changed controllers before the ability resolves, nothing happens.

Kobolds of Kher Keep

{0}

Creature -- Kobold

0/1

Kobolds of Kher Keep is red.

* Kobolds of Kher Keep has a characteristic-defining ability. It works in all zones. If Kobolds of Kher Keep loses all abilities (due to a card like Ovinize), it will still be red because the effect from its ability is applied before the "lose all abilities" effect is applied.

* If Kobolds of Kher Keep is affected by a text-changing effect that changes the color word in its ability (if it's targeted by Sleight of Mind, for example), then its ability will cause it to be the new color word. That's because the text-changing effect is applied before Kobolds of Kher Keep's ability is applied.

Labyrinth Minotaur

{3} {U}

Creature -- Minotaur

1/4

Whenever Labyrinth Minotaur blocks a creature, that creature doesn't untap during its controller's next untap step.

* If the creature Labyrinth Minotaur blocked is untapped at the time its controller's next untap step begins, this ability has no effect. It won't apply at some later time when that creature is tapped.

* Labyrinth Minotaur doesn't track the creature's controller. If the affected creature changes controllers before its old controller's next untap step, this ability will prevent it from being untapped during its new controller's next untap step.

Land Equilibrium

{2} {U} {U}

Enchantment

If an opponent who controls at least as many lands as you do would put a land onto the battlefield, that player instead puts that land onto the battlefield then sacrifices a land.

* This effect applies no matter how the land would enter the battlefield: because an opponent plays it, or because a spell or ability allows that opponent to put it onto the battlefield. Note that it doesn't matter whose control the land enters the battlefield under. If the opponent would put the land onto the battlefield under someone else's control (as a result of Yavimaya Dryad's ability, for example), that opponent will still have to sacrifice a land.

* If an opponent puts a land onto the battlefield under his or her own control, he or she may sacrifice that same land. The player won't be able to tap that land for mana before sacrificing it.

* If a land that would enter the battlefield has its own "If [this land] would enter the battlefield" replacement effect, the player who will control that land chooses which replacement effect to apply. After applying one, if the other one would still be applicable, it's then applied.

Land Tax

{W}

Enchantment

At the beginning of your upkeep, if an opponent controls more lands than you, you may search your library for up to three basic land cards, reveal them, and put them into your hand. If you do, shuffle your library.

* This ability has an "intervening 'if' clause." That means (1) the ability won't trigger at all unless any one of your opponents controls more lands than you, and (2) the ability will do nothing if you control at least as many lands as each of your opponents by the time it resolves.

* You shuffle your library if you search, even if you don't put any basic land cards into your hand.

Lesser Werewolf

{3}{B}

Creature -- Human Wolf

2/4

{B}: If Lesser Werewolf's power is 1 or more, it gets -1/-0 until end of turn and put a -0/-1 counter on target creature blocking or blocked by Lesser Werewolf. Activate this ability only during the declare blockers step.

* You may activate Lesser Werewolf's ability no matter what its power is. However, if Lesser Werewolf's power is 0 or less at the time the ability resolves, the ability won't do anything.

Lightning Blow

{1}{W}

Instant

Target creature gains first strike until end of turn.

Draw a card at the beginning of the next turn's upkeep.

* You may target any creature, not just one that doesn't have first strike. If the targeted creature already has first strike as Lightning Blow resolves, Lightning Blow won't affect it (since multiple instances of first strike are redundant), but you'll still draw a card at the beginning of the next turn's upkeep.

* If the targeted creature doesn't have first strike, granting it first strike after combat damage has been dealt in the first combat damage step won't prevent it from dealing combat damage. It will still assign and deal its combat damage in the second combat damage step.

Living Plane

{2}{G}{G}

World Enchantment

All lands are 1/1 creatures that are still lands.

* Lands that enter the battlefield while Living Plane is on the battlefield will enter the battlefield as creatures. They'll have "summoning sickness" and cannot be tapped for mana until their controller's next turn.

Livonya Silone

{2}{R}{R}{G}{G}

Legendary Creature -- Human Warrior

4/4

First strike, legendary landwalk

* "Legendary landwalk" means "This creature is unblockable as long as defending player controls a legendary land."

Lu Xun, Scholar General

{2} {U} {U}

Legendary Creature -- Human Soldier

1/3

Horsemanship (This creature can't be blocked except by creatures with horsemanship.)

Whenever Lu Xun, Scholar General deals damage to an opponent, you may draw a card.

* Lu Xun's second ability triggers whenever it deals damage to an opponent for any reason. It's not limited to combat damage.

Mana Drain

{U} {U}

Instant

Counter target spell. At the beginning of your next main phase, add {X} to your mana pool, where X is that spell's converted mana cost.

* If the targeted spell "can't be countered," it remains on the stack. Mana Drain continues to resolve. At the beginning of your next main phase, the delayed triggered ability will still add the mana to your mana pool.

* If the targeted spell is an illegal target by the time Mana Drain resolves, Mana Drain is countered. You won't get any mana later.

* Mana Drain's delayed triggered ability will usually trigger at the beginning of your precombat main phase. However, if you cast Mana Drain during your precombat main phase or during your combat phase, its delayed triggered ability will trigger at the beginning of that turn's postcombat main phase.

Mana Vortex

{1} {U} {U}

Enchantment

When you cast Mana Vortex, you may sacrifice a land. If you don't, counter Mana Vortex.

At the beginning of each player's upkeep, that player sacrifices a land.

When there are no lands on the battlefield, sacrifice Mana Vortex.

* When you cast Mana Vortex, its first ability triggers and goes on the stack on top of the Mana Vortex spell. The triggered ability resolves first. When it resolves, you either sacrifice a land or you counter Mana Vortex.

* Mana Vortex's third ability is a "state trigger." Once a state trigger triggers, it won't trigger again as long as the ability is on the stack. If the ability is countered and the trigger condition is still true, it will immediately trigger again.

Misfortune's Gain

{3} {W}

Sorcery

Destroy target creature. Its owner gains 4 life.

* Note that the creature's owner, not its controller, gains 4 life.

* A token creature's owner is the player under whose control it entered the battlefield.

Nebuchadnezzar

{3}{U}{B}

Legendary Creature -- Human Wizard

3/3

{X}, {T}: Name a card. Target opponent reveals X cards at random from his or her hand. That player then discards all cards with that name revealed this way. Activate this ability only during your turn.

* You don't name a card until the ability resolves. Once you name a card, it's too late for the targeted opponent to respond.

* You may activate the ability only during your turn, but you may do so any time you have priority. (In other words, it's not restricted to only the times you could cast a sorcery.)

Nether Void

{3}{B}

World Enchantment

Whenever a player casts a spell, counter it unless its controller pays {3}.

* This is a triggered ability. It's not a static ability that imposes an additional cost.

* The ability triggers whenever any player (including you) casts a spell of any type.

Nicol Bolas

{2}{U}{U}{B}{B}{R}{R}

Legendary Creature -- Elder Dragon

7/7

Flying

At the beginning of your upkeep, sacrifice Nicol Bolas unless you pay {oUoBoR}.

Whenever Nicol Bolas deals damage to an opponent, that player discards his or her hand.

* Nicol Bolas's third ability triggers whenever it deals damage to an opponent for any reason. It's not limited to combat damage.

Nova Pentacle

{4}

Artifact

{3}, {T}: The next time a source of your choice would deal damage to you this turn, that damage is dealt to target creature of an opponent's choice instead.

* As you activate the ability, you choose an opponent, then that opponent chooses a creature for the ability to target. It doesn't have to be a creature that opponent controls. If there are no creatures that can be targeted with the ability, it can't be activated.

* As the ability resolves, you choose a damage source.

* The next time damage from the chosen source would be dealt to you this turn, that damage is dealt to the targeted creature instead. Whether it's still a legal target is not checked at this time. However, if it's not able to be dealt damage because it's neither a creature nor a planeswalker, or it's no longer on the battlefield, then the damage is not redirected and is dealt to you as normal.

Old Man of the Sea

{1} {U} {U}

Creature -- Djinn

2/3

You may choose not to untap Old Man of the Sea during your untap step.

{T}: Gain control of target creature with power less than or equal to Old Man of the Sea's power for as long as Old Man of the Sea remains tapped and that creature's power remains less than or equal to Old Man of the Sea's power.

* If Old Man of the Sea leaves the battlefield, it is no longer tapped, so the duration of its control-change effect ends.

* If Old Man of the Sea stops being tapped before its ability resolves -- even if it becomes tapped again right away -- you won't gain control of the targeted creature at all. The same is true if the targeted creature's power becomes greater than Old Man of the Sea's power before the ability resolves.

* The ability doesn't care whether Old Man of the Sea remains under your control, only that Old Man of the Sea remains tapped and its power remains large enough. If an opponent gains control of Old Man of the Sea, you'll keep control of the affected creature (until Old Man of the Sea stops being tapped or it no longer has enough power).

* Likewise, once the ability resolves, it doesn't care whether the targeted permanent remains a legal target for the ability, only that it's on the battlefield and its power remains small enough. The effect will continue to apply to it even if it gains shroud, stops being a creature, or would no longer be a legal target for any other reason. If it stops being a creature, its power is considered to be 0.

Ramses Overdark

{2} {U} {U} {B} {B}

Legendary Creature -- Human Assassin

4/3

{T}: Destroy target enchanted creature.

* A creature is "enchanted" if it has an Aura attached to it.

Rasputin Dreamweaver

{4} {W} {U}

Legendary Creature -- Human Wizard

4/1

Rasputin Dreamweaver enters the battlefield with seven dream counters on it.

Remove a dream counter from Rasputin: Add {1} to your mana pool.

Remove a dream counter from Rasputin: Prevent the next 1 damage that would be dealt to Rasputin this turn.

At the beginning of your upkeep, if Rasputin started the turn untapped, put a dream counter on it.

Rasputin can't have more than seven dream counters on it.

* The fourth ability has an "intervening 'if' clause," so it won't trigger at all unless Rasputin Dreamweaver started the turn untapped.

* If a number of dream counters would be put on Rasputin Dreamweaver for any reason that would bring the total number of dream counters on it to eight or more, the total number of dream counters on it is brought to seven instead.

* If a permanent with eight or more dream counters on it becomes a copy of Rasputin Dreamweaver (or just gains its last ability), all dream counters except seven are removed from it as a state-based action.

Recall

{X}{X}{U}

Sorcery

Discard X cards, then return a card from your graveyard to your hand for each card discarded this way.
Exile Recall.

* You don't discard cards until Recall resolves. If you don't have X cards in your hand at that time, you discard all the cards in your hand.

* You don't choose which cards in your graveyard you'll return to your hand until after you discard cards. You choose a card in your graveyard for each card you discarded, then you put all cards chosen this way into your hand at the same time. You may choose to return some or all of the cards you just discarded.

Reincarnation

{1}{G}{G}

Instant

Choose target creature. When that creature is put into a graveyard this turn, return a creature card from that graveyard to the battlefield under the control of that creature's owner.

* All Reincarnation does when it resolves is set up a delayed triggered ability. If the targeted creature isn't put into a graveyard this turn, that ability never triggers. If the targeted creature is put into a graveyard this turn, that ability triggers and resolves like any other triggered ability.

* The creature card that will be returned to the battlefield isn't chosen until the delayed triggered ability resolves. The player who chooses is the player who controlled Reincarnation. The player under whose control the chosen creature card enters the battlefield is the player who owned the targeted creature (in other words, the player into whose graveyard it went), not necessarily the controller of that creature.

* The creature that's returned to the battlefield may be the same one that was put into the graveyard (assuming it's still in the graveyard when the delayed triggered ability resolves). If so, it returns to the battlefield as a brand-new creature.

Reveka, Wizard Savant

{2}{U}{U}

Legendary Creature -- Dwarf Wizard

0/1

{T}: Reveka, Wizard Savant deals 2 damage to target creature or player and doesn't untap during your next untap step.

* Reveka's effect causes it not to untap during _your_ next untap step. If another player gains control of it, it will untap during that player's next untap step.

Riding the Dilu Horse

{2}{G}

Sorcery

Target creature gets +2/+2 and gains horsemanship. (It can't be blocked except by creatures with horsemanship. This effect lasts indefinitely.)

* The spell's effect has no duration. The targeted creature gets +2/+2 until the game ends or it leaves the battlefield. It has horsemanship until the game ends, it leaves the battlefield, or some other effect causes it to lose horsemanship.

Rohgahh of Kher Keep

{2}{B}{B}{R}{R}

Legendary Creature -- Kobold

5/5

At the beginning of your upkeep, you may pay {R}{R}{R}. If you don't, tap Rohgahh of Kher Keep and all creatures named Kobolds of Kher Keep, then an opponent gains control of them.

Creatures you control named Kobolds of Kher Keep get +2/+2.

* Rohgahh's first ability isn't targeted. You don't choose the opponent that will gain control of the creatures until the ability resolves.

* If you don't pay {R}{R}{R} as the first ability resolves, all creatures named Kobolds of Kher Keep become tapped (even the ones you don't control), as does Rohgahh. The chosen opponent gains control of Rohgahh and all creatures named Kobolds of Kher Keep regardless of whether you control them or whether they were tapped by the ability.

Rubinia Soulsinger

{2}{G}{W}{U}

Legendary Creature -- Faerie

2/3

You may choose not to untap Rubinia Soulsinger during your untap step.

{T}: Gain control of target creature for as long as you control Rubinia and Rubinia remains tapped.

* If Rubinia Soulsinger leaves the battlefield, you no longer control it, so the duration of its control-change effect ends..

* If Rubinia Soulsinger stops being tapped before its ability resolves -- even if it becomes tapped again right away -- you won't gain control of the targeted creature at all. The same is true if you lose control of Rubinia Soulsinger before the ability resolves.

* Once the ability resolves, it doesn't care whether the targeted permanent remains a legal target for the ability, only that it's on the battlefield. The effect will continue to apply to it even if it gains shroud, stops being a creature, or would no longer be a legal target for any other reason.

Slashing Tiger

{2}{G}{G}

Creature -- Cat

3/3

Whenever Slashing Tiger becomes blocked, it gets +2/+2 until end of turn.

* When Slashing Tiger becomes blocked, the ability will trigger just once no matter how many creatures are blocking it.

Sorrow's Path

Land

{T}: Choose two target blocking creatures an opponent controls. If each of those creatures could block all creatures that the other is blocking, remove both of them from combat. Each one then blocks all creatures the other was blocking.

Whenever Sorrow's Path becomes tapped, it deals 2 damage to you and each creature you control.

* The first ability can target any two blocking creatures a single opponent controls. Whether those creatures could block all creatures the other is blocking isn't determined until the ability resolves.

* A "blocking creature" is one that has been declared as a blocker this combat, or one that was put onto the battlefield blocking this combat. Unless that creature leaves combat, it continues to be a blocking creature through the end of combat step, even if the creature or creatures that it was blocking are no longer on the battlefield or have otherwise left combat by then.

* When Sorrow's Path's first ability is activated, its second ability triggers and goes on the stack on top of the first ability. The second ability resolves first, and may cause some of the attacking creatures to be dealt lethal damage.

* When determining whether a creature could block all creatures the other is blocking, take into account evasion abilities (like flying), protection abilities, and other blocking restrictions, as well as abilities that allow a creature to block multiple creatures or block as though a certain condition were true. Take into account whether those creatures are tapped, but not whether they have costs to block (since those apply only as blockers are declared).

* When the first ability resolves, if all the creatures that one of the targeted creatures was blocking have left combat, then the other targeted creature is considered to be able to block all creatures the first creature is blocking. If the ability has its full effect, the second creature will be removed from combat but not returned to combat; it doesn't block anything.

* Abilities that trigger whenever one of the targeted creatures blocks will trigger when the first ability resolves, because those creatures will change from not blocking (since they're removed from combat) to blocking. It doesn't matter if those abilities triggered when those creatures blocked the first time. Abilities that trigger whenever one of the attacking creatures becomes blocked will not trigger again, because they never stopped being blocked creatures. Abilities that trigger whenever a creature blocks one of the attacking creatures will trigger again, though; those kinds of abilities trigger once for each creature that blocks.

* Sorrow's Path's second ability triggers whenever it becomes tapped for any reason, not just when its first ability is activated.

Spectral Shield

{1}{W}{U}

Enchantment -- Aura

Enchant creature

Enchanted creature gets +0/+2 and can't be the target of spells.

* The enchanted creature can still be the target of abilities.

Spiny Starfish

{2}{U}

Creature -- Starfish

0/1

{U}: Regenerate Spiny Starfish.

At the beginning of the end step, if Spiny Starfish regenerated this turn, put a 0/1 blue Starfish creature token onto the battlefield for each time it regenerated this turn.

* Spiny Starfish's first ability creates a regeneration shield for it. Spiny Starfish's second ability checks whether it used any regeneration shields that turn, not whether any regeneration shields were created for it.

* The second ability doesn't care where the regeneration shields Spiny Starfish used that turn came from. If it regenerated due to a regeneration shield from Refresh, for example, the ability will still put a Starfish token onto the battlefield.

* The second ability has an "intervening 'if' clause," so it won't trigger at all unless Spiny Starfish had regenerated that turn. However, the number of tokens that are created isn't determined until the ability resolves (in case it regenerates again before that time).

* If Spiny Starfish regenerates during the end step after its second ability has resolved, no tokens will be created as a result.

Spirit Shackle

{B} {B}

Enchantment -- Aura

Enchant creature

Whenever enchanted creature becomes tapped, put a -0/-2 counter on it.

* Spirit Shackle's ability triggers only when the enchanted creature changes from untapped to tapped. If Spirit Shackle enters the battlefield attached to an already tapped creature, it won't do anything (until that creature untaps and becomes tapped again, that is).

Spoils of Victory

{2} {G}

Sorcery

Search your library for a Plains, Island, Swamp, Mountain, or Forest card and put that card onto the battlefield. Then shuffle your library.

* Spoils of Victory allows you to search your library for any card with the land type Plains, Island, Swamp, Mountain, or Forest, not just a card with one of those names.

Stangg

{4} {R} {G}

Legendary Creature -- Human Warrior

3/4

When Stangg enters the battlefield, put a legendary 3/4 red and green Human Warrior creature token named Stangg Twin onto the battlefield. When Stangg leaves the battlefield, exile that token. When that token leaves the battlefield, sacrifice Stangg.

* Stangg's delayed triggered abilities track only the token created by that particular Stangg.

* If Stangg leaves the battlefield before its ability has resolved, that ability will still create a Stangg Twin token, but its delayed triggered abilities will never have a chance to trigger. That token will remain on the battlefield indefinitely (until it's dealt lethal damage, or anything else causes it to leave the battlefield).

Stolen Grain

{4} {B} {B}

Sorcery

Stolen Grain deals 5 damage to target opponent. You gain 5 life.

* If the targeted opponent is an illegal target by the time Stolen Grain resolves, the ability is countered. You won't gain life.

Storm World

{R}

World Enchantment

At the beginning of each player's upkeep, Storm World deals X damage to that player, where X is 4 minus the number of cards in his or her hand.

* If the player whose turn it is has four or more cards in his or her hand as Storm World's ability resolves, the ability just won't do anything that turn.

Strategic Planning

{1} {U}

Sorcery

Look at the top three cards of your library. Put one of them into your hand and the rest into your graveyard.

* If there are fewer than three cards in your library, you look at all of them, put one of them into your hand, and put the rest into your graveyard.

Sun Quan, Lord of Wu

{4} {U} {U}

Legendary Creature -- Human Soldier

4/4

Creatures you control have horsemanship. (They can't be blocked except by creatures with horsemanship.)

* Sun Quan's ability affects Sun Quan itself.

Sword of the Ages

{6}

Artifact

Sword of the Ages enters the battlefield tapped.

{T}, Exile Sword of the Ages and any number of creatures you control: Sword of the Ages deals X damage to target creature or player, where X is the total power of the creatures exiled this way.

* The activated ability checks the power the exiled creatures had as they last existed on the battlefield.

Takklemaggot

{2} {B} {B}

Enchantment -- Aura

Enchant creature

At the beginning of the upkeep of enchanted creature's controller, put a -0/-1 counter on that creature.

When enchanted creature is put into a graveyard, that creature's controller chooses a creature that Takklemaggot could enchant. If he or she does, return Takklemaggot to the battlefield under your control attached to that creature. If he or she doesn't, return Takklemaggot to the battlefield under your control as a non-Aura enchantment. It loses "enchant creature" and gains "At the beginning of that player's upkeep, Takklemaggot deals 1 damage to him or her."

* When the enchanted creature is put into a graveyard, Takklemaggot's second ability triggers, then Takklemaggot is put into its owner's graveyard as a state-based action. When the ability resolves, if Takklemaggot is still in that graveyard, it's returned to the battlefield.

* Takklemaggot returns to the battlefield under the control of the player who controlled it when it left (even though it's now a brand-new permanent).

* The player who controlled the creature that went to the graveyard (and caused Takklemaggot's second ability to trigger) chooses what creature Takklemaggot will return to the battlefield attached to. The creature isn't chosen until the ability resolves, so no player can respond between the time the creature is chosen and the time Takklemaggot returns to the battlefield attached to it. The ability doesn't target a creature, so a creature with shroud, for example, can be chosen. However, only a creature that can be legally enchanted by Takklemaggot can be chosen, so a creature with protection from black, for example, can't be chosen. If the player can choose a creature, he or she must do so, no matter who controls it. If the player can't choose a creature, Takklemaggot returns to the battlefield as a non-Aura enchantment, and that player is the player that Takklemaggot will deal damage to.

* If the enchanted creature leaves the battlefield but isn't put into a graveyard, Takklemaggot is simply put into its owner's graveyard as a state-based action. Its ability won't trigger, and it won't return to the battlefield.

Tetsuo Umezawa

{U} {B} {R}

Legendary Creature -- Human Archer

3/3

Tetsuo Umezawa can't be the target of Aura spells.

{U} {B} {B} {R}, {T}: Destroy target tapped or blocking creature.

* Tetsuo Umezawa can be targeted by abilities from Auras.

* Although Tetsuo Umezawa can't be targeted by Aura spells as they are cast, it can be enchanted. A spell or ability can move an Aura from another permanent onto Tetsuo, or can put an Aura onto the battlefield attached to Tetsuo.

The Abyss

{3} {B}

World Enchantment

At the beginning of each player's upkeep, destroy target nonartifact creature that player controls of his or her choice. It can't be regenerated.

* The player who controls The Abyss when the ability triggers controls the ability, but the player whose upkeep it is chooses the target.

The Wretched

{3} {B} {B}

Creature -- Demon

2/5

At end of combat, gain control of all creatures blocking The Wretched for as long as you control The Wretched.

* The Wretched's ability triggers only if it's still on the battlefield when the end of combat step begins (after the combat damage step). For example, if it's blocked by a 7/7 creature and is destroyed, its ability won't trigger at all.

* Its ability has you gain control of all creatures it's currently blocked by, not necessarily the creatures it had become blocked by during that combat phase. For example, if The Wretched is dealt lethal combat damage and regenerates, it's removed from combat. Its ability will trigger at end of combat, but since it's no longer blocked by any creatures, the ability won't do anything.

* If The Wretched leaves the battlefield, you no longer control it, so the duration of its control-change effect ends.

* If you lose control of The Wretched before its ability resolves, you won't gain control of the creatures blocking it at all.

* Once the ability resolves, it doesn't care whether the permanents you gained control of remain creatures, only that they remain on the battlefield.

Three Visits

{1} {G}

Sorcery

Search your library for a Forest card and put that card onto the battlefield. Then shuffle your library.

* Three Visits allows you to search your library for any card with the land type Forest, not just a card with the name Forest.

Tracker

{2} {G}

Creature -- Human

2/2

{G} {G}, {T}: Tracker deals damage equal to its power to target creature. That creature deals damage equal to its power to Tracker.

* If the targeted creature leaves the battlefield (or otherwise becomes an illegal target) before the ability resolves, the ability is countered. Tracker isn't dealt damage.

* On the other hand, if Tracker leaves the battlefield before the ability resolves, the ability continues to resolve. Tracker deals damage to the targeted creature equal to the power Tracker had as it last existed on the battlefield.

* You may have Tracker target itself with its own ability. If you do, Tracker will deal damage to itself equal to its power, then immediately do it again.

Urborg

Legendary Land

{T}: Add {B} to your mana pool.

{T}: Target creature loses first strike or swampwalk until end of turn.

* You can target any creature with Urborg's second ability, not just one with first strike or swampwalk. (Of course, the ability has no effect on a creature without first strike or swampwalk.)

* You choose whether the targeted creature loses first strike or swampwalk as the ability resolves. If the creature has both abilities, it will lose just one of them.

* Causing a creature to lose swampwalk is useful only during the declare attackers step or earlier. Once the declare blockers step begins, it's too late to block the creature.

* If the targeted creature has first strike, causing it to lose first strike after combat damage has been dealt in the first combat damage step won't allow it to deal combat damage in the second combat damage step.

* Urborg's second ability affects only the first strike ability, not the part of the double strike ability that acts like first strike.

Voodoo Doll

{6}

Artifact

At the beginning of your upkeep, put a pin counter on Voodoo Doll.

At the beginning of your end step, if Voodoo Doll is untapped, it deals damage to you equal to the number of pin counters on it. If Voodoo Doll deals damage to you this way, destroy it.

{X} {X}, {T}: Voodoo Doll deals X damage to target creature or player. X is the number of pin counters on Voodoo Doll.

* Voodoo Doll's second ability has an "intervening 'if' clause." That means (1) the ability won't trigger at all unless Voodoo Doll is untapped, and (2) the ability will do nothing if Voodoo Doll is tapped by the time it resolves. If Voodoo Doll is no longer on the battlefield as the ability resolves, its last existence on the battlefield is checked to see if it was tapped or untapped.

* Voodoo Doll's second ability causes it to be destroyed only if it actually deals damage to you. If all the damage is prevented or redirected, Voodoo Doll isn't destroyed.

* Each X in the cost of Voodoo Doll's third ability is the number of pin counters on Voodoo Doll at the time you activate the ability. The X in the ability's effect is the number of pin counters on Voodoo Doll at the time it resolves, which may not be the same number (if a spell or ability put counters on it or removed counters from it in the meantime). If Voodoo Doll is no longer on the battlefield as the ability resolves, its last existence on the battlefield is checked to see how many pin counters were on it.

Wandering Mage

{W} {U} {B}

Creature -- Human Cleric Wizard

0/3

{W}, Pay 1 life: Prevent the next 2 damage that would be dealt to target creature this turn.

{U}: Prevent the next 1 damage that would be dealt to target Cleric or Wizard creature this turn.

{B}, Put a -1/-1 counter on a creature you control: Prevent the next 2 damage that would be dealt to target player this turn.

* The second ability checks that the targeted creature is a Cleric or Wizard only at the time the ability is activated and at the time it resolves. It doesn't check at the time the damage is actually prevented.

* If you activate Wandering Mage's third ability, you put the -1/-1 counter on a creature you control as a cost. That means it happens when you activate the ability, not when it resolves. If paying the cost causes the only creature you control to have 0 toughness, it's put into the graveyard before you can pay the cost again.

Wei Night Raiders

{2} {B} {B}

Creature -- Human Soldier

2/2

Horsemanship (This creature can't be blocked except by creatures with horsemanship.)

Whenever Wei Night Raiders deals damage to an opponent, that player discards a card.

* Wei Night Raiders's second ability triggers whenever it deals damage to an opponent for any reason. It's not limited to combat damage.

Willow Satyr

{2} {G} {G}

Creature -- Satyr

1/1

You may choose not to untap Willow Satyr during your untap step.

{T}: Gain control of target legendary creature for as long as you control Willow Satyr and Willow Satyr remains tapped.

* If Willow Satyr leaves the battlefield, you no longer control it, so the duration of its control-change effect ends.

* If Willow Satyr stops being tapped before its ability resolves -- even if it becomes tapped again right away -- you won't gain control of the targeted creature at all. The same is true if you lose control of Willow Satyr before the ability resolves.

* Once the ability resolves, it doesn't care whether the targeted permanent remains a legal target for the ability, only that it's on the battlefield. The effect will continue to apply to it even if it gains shroud, stops being a creature, stops being legendary, or would no longer be a legal target for any other reason.

Wormwood Treefolk

{3} {G} {G}

Creature -- Treefolk

4/4

{G} {G}: Wormwood Treefolk gains forestwalk until end of turn and deals 2 damage to you.

{B} {B}: Wormwood Treefolk gains swampwalk until end of turn and deals 2 damage to you.

* Causing Wormwood Treefolk to gain forestwalk or swampwalk is useful only during the declare attackers step or earlier. Once it becomes blocked, giving it a landwalk ability won't change that.

Xiahou Dun, the One-Eyed

{2} {B} {B}

Legendary Creature -- Human Soldier

3/2

Horsemanship (This creature can't be blocked except by creatures with horsemanship.)

Sacrifice Xiahou Dun, the One-Eyed: Return target black card from your graveyard to your hand. Activate this ability only during your turn, before attackers are declared.

* You can't activate Xiahou Dun's ability to return Xiahou Dun itself to your hand. You must choose a target before you sacrifice Xiahou Dun, so it's not a black card in your graveyard yet.

Zodiac Dragon

{7} {R} {R}

Creature -- Dragon

8/8

When Zodiac Dragon is put into your graveyard from the battlefield, you may return it to your hand.

* If Zodiac Dragon is removed from the graveyard after the ability triggers but before it resolves, you can't return it to your hand. Similarly, if a replacement effect has Zodiac Dragon move to a different zone instead of being put into the graveyard, the ability won't trigger at all.

* Even though Zodiac Dragon is a Dragon, it doesn't have flying.

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